



iPhone 12 leaks

Details of the next generation of iPhone have emerged from an apparent leak, including the A14 Bionic chip. <https://digit.in/aug20-63>



Smartphone shipments down

A report shows that smartphone shipments in India reduced by 48 percent in Q2 2020. <https://digit.in/aug20-64>

JBL Quantum 400 gaming headset

A versatile mid-range offering in the JBL Quantum lineup

M

ultiple audio brands today are looking to expand beyond their market

segment, and delve into newer areas. JBL, a name that's well-known in the audio space, has now forayed into the lucrative gaming space. We received the JBL Quantum 400 gaming headset for review. Let's look at how it fared.

Build and design

The bold, gamer aesthetic of the JBL Quantum 400 is evident from the moment you set your eyes on the box. Within the box, you will find two robust, braided cables – a three-meter-long USB Type-C to Type-A cable for PC gaming and a 1.2 meter-long 3.5mm audio cable for all other platforms.

Now, coming to the headset, the JBL Quantum 400 are circumaural headphones that come with large, memory foam padded ear cups with a soft leatherette material atop. They are sturdy yet lightweight, weighing merely 274g. The large, oval-shaped ear cups have the RGB-lit, JBL logos etched onto the back panels.

The cups are mounted on swivels and can turn 180-degrees. The headband has a ton of flex and is also adjustable to up to 7 levels. The left ear cup houses all the controls and connectivity ports including the USB-C port, the 3.5mm port, the mute button, the volume wheel and the game chat dial. The controls are easy to reach and use, but, the game chat dial is a tad rickety. The microphone also resides on the left earcup and it has a nifty flip-to-mute mechanism, which we loved.

Comfort

The Quantum 400's plush, memory foam ear cups and the soft padding on the headband ensures comfort over long gaming sessions. The clamping force is not tight enough to be overwhelming but is also not loose enough that it hampers the seal. The leatherette



material on the cups, however, can make some users' ears warm over extended gaming sessions which can lead to sweating.

Software

If you are using the Quantum 400 with your Windows PC, you will get access to JBL's QuantumEngine software. The first tab in the software hosts a fully customisable EQ and multiple sound presets such as Bass Boost, Bass Cut, Clarity, FPS, Flat, etc. The second tab gives you granular levels of control over the RGB-lit, JBL logos. You also have a few presets here that you can choose from, or you can delve deep into minutely tweaking the lighting.

The third tab allows you to access to JBL QuantumSurround and DTS. Here, you can choose to enable QuantumSurround, DTS or turn the spatial sound off. The fourth tab allows you to control microphone settings by controlling the microphone levels, the microphone volume, and sidetone. Overall, the software's interface is quite intuitive and highly dynamic.

Performance

The JBL QuantumSurround 400 is a simulated 7.1 surround sound experience that offers solid directional imaging in games. DTS is a toned-down version of Surround Sound with an overall smaller soundstage and a

tighter auditory experience. Gaming in general on the JBL Quantum 400, whether you're on PC or console, is a rather enjoyable experience. Melodies in games are prominent and well-balanced. Even with just stereo sound, the imaging is quite accurate and the natural soundstage is sufficiently wide. The Quantum 400 also comes equipped with a game chat dial that

allows you to adjust the volume levels based on priority for game sounds and chat sounds, which

can prove to be pretty useful. When listening to music, the JBL Quantum 400 features commendable mids, soaring highs, but a slightly underwhelming bass response.



BUILD	74
FEATURES.....	73
PERFORMANCE.....	78
VALUE.....	68

Microphone

The microphone on the JBL Quantum 400 gaming headset is excellent. It picks up your voice naturally and relays it with clarity. The microphone is a directional microphone that doesn't pick up too much background chatter.

Bottomline

The JBL Quantum 400 gaming headset is a versatile, mid-range gaming headset packed with a plethora of customisation options. JBL's QuantumSurround brings life and extra tactility and immersion to games, and the flip-to-mute microphone is convenient. These headphones also offer an immersive soundstage and stellar imaging.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

FREQUENCY RESPONSE: 20 Hz - 20 kHz | MICROPHONE FREQUENCY | RESPONSE: 100 Hz - 10 kHz | MAX INPUT POWER: 30 mW | SENSITIVITY: 98 dB SPL @1 kHz / 1mW | IMPEDANCE: 32 ohm | MICROPHONE PICKUP PATTERN: Directional | WEIGHT: 274 g | CABLE LENGTH: 3.5mm audio cable (1.2 m) + Type-C to Type-A Cable (3 m) | DRIVER SIZE: 50 mm dynamic drivers

CONTACT

JBL BY HARMAN | PHONE: 18001020525 | EMAIL: Web form | WEBSITE: <https://in.jbl.com/>